

Incident Case Report Template

1. Case Information

- **Case ID:** 003
- **Case Title:** Curl.exe
- **Date / Time of Detection:** Sep. 12, 2025 18:11:35 (2025-09-12 16:11:35 UTC)
- **Reported by:** CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR Alert)
- **Case Owner:** Ali YILMAZ

2. Incident Summary

- **Description of the Incident:**
A curl.exe process was executed through cmd.exe to download a remote file.
This activity is suspicious because normal end-users typically do not use curl.exe to connect to websites or download files directly.
Such behavior is often associated with adversaries leveraging curl.exe as a “living-off-the-land” binary to retrieve malicious payloads from external sources.
- **Initial Alert Source:**
CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR Alert)
- **Classification:**
T1105 - Ingress Tool Transfer
- **Severity Level:** High

3. Investigation Details

3.1 Indicators of Compromise (IoCs)

- **IP Addresses:** 213.6.54.58
- **Domains / URLs:** microsoft-telemetry.cc
- **File Hashes:**
3345339164cf384eff527b6c3160fea8d849a4231ec6ca80513e3a739e505168

3.2 OSINT & Threat Intelligence Findings

- **VirusTotal:** Matches rule Suspicious Curl.EXE Download by Florian Roth (Nextron Systems), Nasreddine Bencherchali (Nextron Systems) at Sigma Integrated Rule Set (GitHub)

- *Detects a suspicious curl process start on Windows and outputs the requested document to a local file*

4. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Tactic (Category)	Technique (ID & Name)	Evidence in Case
Initial Access	T1105 - Ingress Tool Transfer	[Yes]
Execution	T1204 (User Execution) → <i>PowerShell executed by user interaction</i>	[No]
Persistence	T1547 – Boot or Logon Autostart Execution	[No]
Privilege Escalation	N/A	N/A
Defense Evasion	N/A	N/A
Credential Access	T1110 – Brute Force	[No]
Discovery	N/A	N/A
Lateral Movement	N/A	N/A
Collection	N/A	N/A
Exfiltration	N/A	N/A
Command and Control (C2)	T1071 – Application Layer Protocol	[No]

(Fill only relevant ones, mark N/A if not applicable)

5. Timeline of Events

Time (UTC)	Event Description	Source (Log/Alert)	Notes
Sep. 12, 2025 18:11:35 (2025-09-12 16:11:35 UTC)	Detection of alert	CrowdStrike Falcon (EDR Alert)	...

Time (UTC)	Event Description	Source (Log/Alert)	Notes
[2025-09-14]	Analyst OSINT check started	VirusTotal	...
[(2025-09-14]	Escalation / Ticket created	#6305 TheHive	...

6. Result & Assessment

- **Final Verdict:** [True Positive – Contained]
- **Impact Assessment:**
 - Affected Users/Hosts: [DESKTOP-44AO68N]
 - Business Impact: [High] The execution of `curl.exe` via `cmd.exe` to download a file indicates an attempt to retrieve a potential malicious payload. If successful, this could have led to endpoint compromise, malware execution, and subsequent lateral movement within the corporate network. Such activity poses a **high risk** to business continuity, data confidentiality, and overall endpoint integrity.

7. Recommended Actions

- **Technical Actions (SOC):**
 - Block IOC hash
 - Block IP Address
 - Block Domain Name
 - Quarantine affected host(s)
 - Review SIEM logs for correlation
- **Organizational / HR Actions:**
 - Conduct awareness training for end-users, emphasizing that command-line tools (such as `curl.exe`) are not to be used for browsing or file downloads.
 - Notify the affected user about the suspicious activity observed under their account/host.
 - Escalate to HR only if investigation confirms policy violation (e.g., intentional misuse of system tools).

8. Case Closure

- **Closure Date:** Sep. 13, 2025 13:00
- **Closed by:** Ali YILMAZ
- **Case Status:** Closed

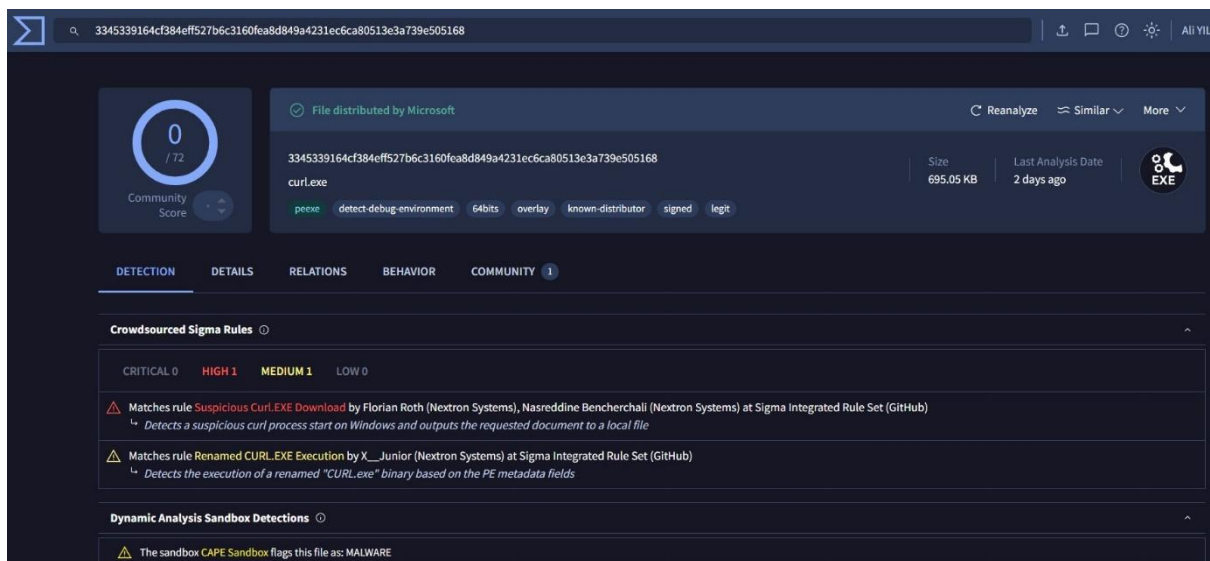
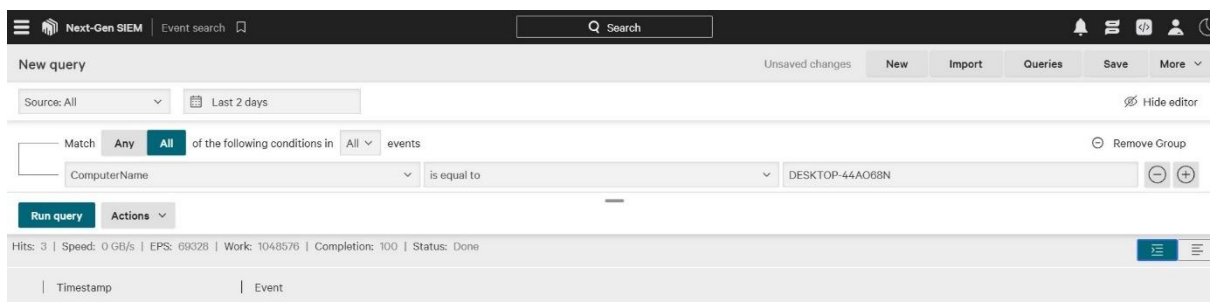
Screenshots:

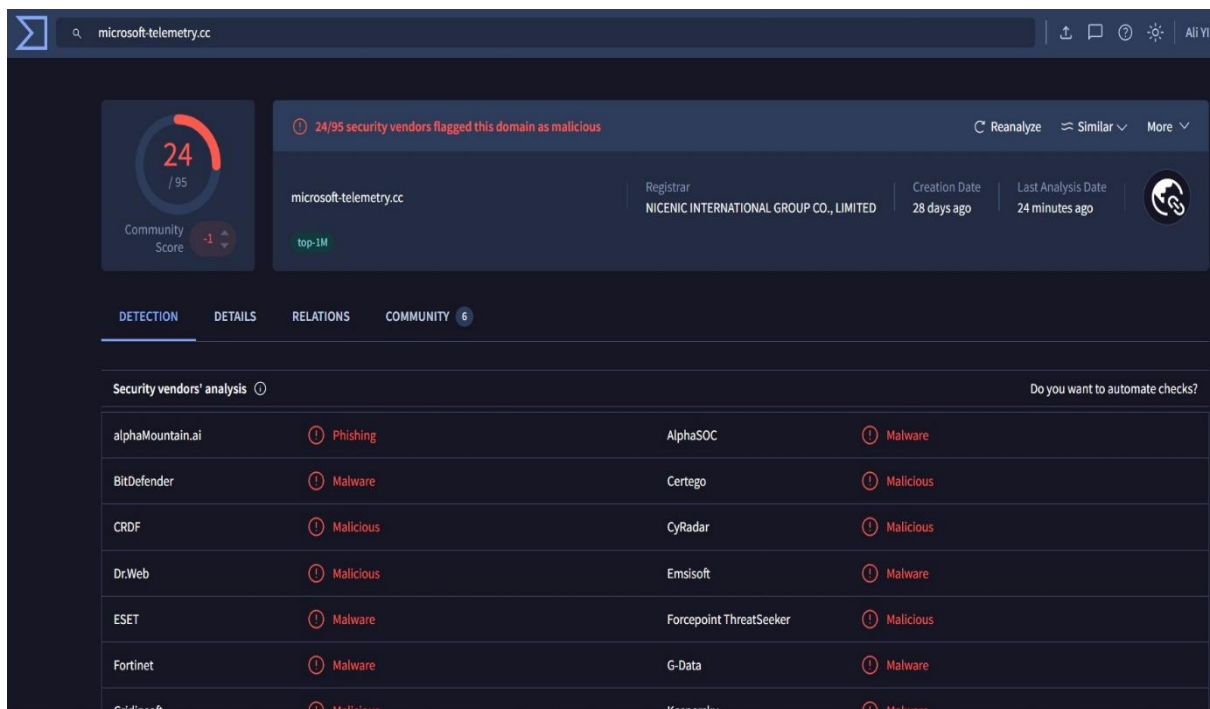
The screenshot displays the CrowdStrike endpoint security interface for a specific process. The main header shows the process name **curl.exe on DESKTOP-44A068N** and the timestamp **Sep. 12, 2025 18:11:35**. The interface is divided into several sections:

- Description:** A domain lookup matched a CrowdStrike Intelligence Indicator that has previously been used in targeted attacks.
- Summary:** A table providing key details:

Category	Value
Severity	High
Process	curl.exe
Tactics & techniques	Execution, Persistence, Defense Evasion
Start time	Sep. 12, 2025 18:11:35
End time	Sep. 12, 2025 18:11:36
Assigned to	Unassigned
Status	New
Related host	DESKTOP-44A068N at 2025-09-11 10:54:22
- Detections in this group (1):** A table showing the detection details:

Severity	Process	Start time	End time	Tactics & techniques
High	curl.exe	Sep. 12, 2025 18:11:35	Sep. 12, 2025 18:11:36	Execution, Persistence, Defense Evasion
- Full details:** A section providing a comprehensive overview of the process, including its command line, associated indicators, and a list of related processes.
- Hash:** A section displaying the file's hash and a list of related processes.
- File:** A section showing the file's properties, including its name, size, and a list of related processes.
- Quarantined files:** A section listing files that have been quarantined, with a red box highlighting the file **845b6c1d6552200899b4c026a4e1111b7ac8b14e4d43a391d38042d401**.
- Host:** A section showing the host's details, including its name, IP address, and a list of related processes.
- User:** A section showing the user's details, including their name, email address, and a list of related processes.
- Process actions:** A section showing the actions taken on the process, including network operations, disk operations, and DNS requests.
- Network operations:** A section showing the network connections made by the process, with a red box highlighting the connection to **192.168.1.100**.
- Disk operations:** A section showing the disk operations performed by the process, including file reads and writes.
- DNS requests:** A section showing the DNS requests made by the process, with a red box highlighting the request for **microsoft telemetry**.
- Status log:** A section showing the status of the process, with a red box highlighting the status **No events**.





MITRE | ATT&CK

Matrices Tactics Techniques Defenses CTI Resources Benefactors Blog Search

TECHNIQUES

- Hide Infrastructure
- Ingress Tool Transfer**
- Multi-Stage Channels
- Non-Application Layer Protocol
- Non-Standard Port
- Protocol Tunneling
- Proxy
- Remote Access
- Tools
- Traffic Signaling
- Web Service
- Exfiltration
- Impact
- Mobile
- ICS

Ingress Tool Transfer

Adversaries may transfer tools or other files from an external system into a compromised environment. Tools or files may be copied from an external adversary-controlled system to the victim network through the command and control channel or through alternate protocols such as `ftp`. Once present, adversaries may also transfer/spread tools between victim devices within a compromised environment (i.e. [Lateral Tool Transfer](#)).

On Windows, adversaries may use various utilities to download tools, such as `copy`, `finger`, `certutil`, and PowerShell commands such as `TEX(New-Object Net.WebClient).downloadString()` and `Invoke-WebRequest`. On Linux and macOS systems, a variety of utilities also exist, such as `curl`, `scp`, `sftp`, `tftp`, `rsync`, `finger`, and `wget`.^[1] A number of these tools, such as `wget`, `curl`, and `scp`, also exist on ESXi. After downloading a file, a threat actor may attempt to verify its integrity by checking its hash value (e.g., via `certutil -hashfile`).^[2]

Adversaries may also abuse installers and package managers, such as `yum` or `winget`, to download tools to victim hosts. Adversaries have also abused file application features, such as the Windows `search-ms` protocol handler, to deliver malicious files to victims through remote file searches invoked by [User Execution](#) (typically after interacting with [Phishing lures](#)).^[3]

Files can also be transferred using various [Web Services](#) as well as native or otherwise present tools on the victim system.^[4] In some cases, adversaries may be able to leverage services that sync between a web-based and an on-premises client, such as [Dropbox](#) or [OneDrive](#), to transfer files onto

ID: T1105

Sub-techniques: No sub-techniques

① **Tactic:** [Command and Control](#)

① **Platforms:** ESXi, Linux, Network Devices, Windows, macOS

Contributors: Alain Homewood; Jeremy Hedges; Joe Wise; John Page (aka hyp3rlinx); ApparitionSec; Mark Wee; Peter Oakes; Selena Larson, @selenalarson; Shailesh Tiwary (Indian Army); The DFIR Report

Version: 2.5

Created: 31 May 2017

Last Modified: 15 April 2025

[Version](#) [Permalink](#)